- In children it is required for good appetite and proper growth.

Food sources



Sources of Vitamin B

Sunflower seeds, peanuts, wheat bran, beet liver, pork, seafood, egg – yolk, beans whole grains and yeast contain good amounts of thiamine.

Deficiency

Beriberi occurs in two forms, wet beriberi and dry beriberi, whose prominent symptoms differ.

Riboflavin – (Vitamin B2)

Riboflavin is another B – complex vitamin involved as a coenzyme in the metabolism of carbohydrates, as well as of fats and proteins. The adult RDA for riboflavin has been established at a minimum of 1.2 milligrams per day.

Functions

- It is required by the body to use oxygen and the metabolism of amino acids, fatty acids, and carbohydrates.
- It is a used for red blood cell formation, antibody production, cell respiration, and growth.
- It may be helpful in the prevention and treatment of cataracts.

Food sources

Organ meats, nuts, cheese, eggs, milk and lean meat are best sources of riboflavin. It is also available in good quantities in green leafy vegetables, fish, legumes, whole grains, and yogurt.

Deficiency

A dietary deficiency of riboflavin leads to ariboflavinosis.

Niacin (B3)

Niacin also called nicotinic acid or niacin amide and can be manufactured by body. Niacin is derived from two compounds – nicotinic acid and niacin amide.

Functions

- Niacin functions as a coenzyme in nearly all the metabolic pathways yielding energy from carbohydrates, fats, proteins, and alcohol.
- Niacin also plays a role in tissue respiration.
- It is involved in the synthesis and breakdown of fats, and helps to maintain healthy skin.

Food sources

Liver, lean meat, fish, nuts, cereals, legumes, asparagus, milk, green leafy vegetables and fish. A cup of coffee also provides 3 milligrams of niacin.

Deficiency

A deficiency of niacin is known as pellagra, which means rough skin (from the Italian words pelle for skin and Agra for rough).

Pyridoxine (Vitamin B6)

Pyridoxine is part of the B group vitamins and is water – soluble and is required for both mental and physical health.

Functions

- Pyridoxine is required for the balancing of hormonal changes in women.

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